wildly accusing the CIA, the State Department, and anybody else, of being in league with the opposition to harm his father, was apparently told by the father himself to shut up; he chose to leave the country for a time.

Saturday, April 15

Demonstrations against the judicial overhaul remain strong: 140,000 protest in Tel Aviv, thousands more all over the country. In Netanya, demonstrators against the reform and demonstrators supporting it. The city is largely in the hands of Shas and other coalition parties.

Testimonies about the now notorious Jerusalem religious girls yeshiva (Horev) are coming out on the news: “racist and elitist.” Actually, we all knew that the Lithuanian ultra-Orthodox yeshivot, and their communities more generally, avoided the inclusion of Sephardi Jews—one more reason for the creation of Shas. The truth is that in our daily life in Jerusalem, we kept to strictly Ashkenazi acquaintances, to a homogeneous Ashkenazi community, without ever thinking of it or discussing it. It was natural. But I think that it was also natural on the other side, the Sephardi one, not to mix socially with Ashkenazis. Perhaps so, but it was probably resented. In the schools, there was profiling. If you were Sephardi, you were not automatically directed to a secondary school, but rather to a professional one.

On the lighter side: one of my children had a Sephardi friend at school, who somehow managed to enter the Jerusalem Rehavia Gymnasium. This friend had to write an essay in history on the uprising of the Warsaw Ghetto. I wrote the essay and did my best. The teacher didn’t like the result. The kid, probably then in eleventh or twelfth grade, got a bad mark. Did I write a poor essay or was this some late profiling?

Nowadays, the resentment finds unabashed political expression, cleverly manipulated by Netanyahu. Of course, he did not miss the chance to attend